

## **Guidance Note: Navigating the Green Climate Fund (GCF) Pre-screening questionnaire under the revised Accreditation Framework**

### **1. Introduction: What is GCF Pre-screening?**

The Green Climate Fund's pre-screening questionnaire is the first step in the accreditation process, introduced as part of the revised Accreditation Framework (RAF) adopted at the forty-second meeting of the Board in 2025. Pre-screening serves as an initial eligibility check for entities wishing to become GCF Accredited Entities (AEs). In simple terms, it's a focused set of questions to confirm that an entity meets the core requirements to partner with GCF before an applicant invests time and resources in a full accreditation application. This approach helps make the accreditation process faster and more efficient by ensuring that only applicants that are fit for the AE role move forward.

### **2. Pre-screening in the revised Accreditation Framework Process**

Under the new staged, fit-for-purpose, risk-based model of the RAF, accreditation is split into clear steps, and requirements are tailored to each entity's context and intended level of engagement. Pre-screening is a critical early stage in this model.

**Staged approach:** The RAF outlines a step-by-step accreditation journey. Pre-screening is Step 2, coming right after the initial nomination/self-nomination and before the full application stage. GCF conducts pre-screening as a preliminary check of basic eligibility and capacity. Only those who pass are invited to proceed to Step 3 comprising: submission of the full application and a detailed review. This staging makes the process more manageable and predictable for applicants.

**Fit-for-purpose and risk-based process:** The RAF is designed to accommodate different types of institutions and the varying risk profiles of the projects they intend to undertake. Pre-screening supports this fit-for-purpose approach by quickly assessing an applicant's fundamental capacity and readiness for the role of an AE. In essence, it confirms that an entity has the foundational systems and authority in place to handle GCF projects commensurate with its size and risk level. For example, an entity aiming for high-risk, large-scale projects will eventually be assessed against relevant standards and requirements, but regardless of size or risk category, every applicant must first demonstrate certain universal qualifications at pre-screening.

**Streamlining and efficiency:** By filtering out ineligible applicants early, pre-screening helps streamline the workload for both the applicant and GCF. Pre-screening contributes to this by preventing situations where an entity might invest time and resources on preparing and submitting an application only to find they were missing a fundamental requirement. It also allows the GCF Secretariat to focus its detailed due diligence efforts (and applicants' time) on candidates that have the necessary underlying qualifications.

**Support during pre-screening:** Importantly, pre-screening is not a test but rather a guide for an entity and the Secretariat on the expectations and responsibilities of a GCF AE. The GCF Secretariat provides guidance and outreach during this stage. For example, GCF will organize information sessions and engage with prospective applicants (and their National Designated Authorities, or NDAs) before and

during the pre-screening process. This means applicants can ask questions and understand what is expected, ensuring the process is as clear and supportive as possible. Please monitor the [GCF website](#) for the announcements and recordings of the information sessions. Applicants can also send inquiries to this email: [dinvs.pre.screening@gcfund.org](mailto:dinvs.pre.screening@gcfund.org)

### **3. Key Requirements Checked during Pre-Screening (What to Expect)**

The pre-screening questionnaire will focus on a few core requirements to determine if an entity is fundamentally fit for and ready to become an AE. Essentially, GCF is seeking to confirm that applicants have the legal standing and basic capabilities to take on the responsibilities of an AE.

There are three sections in the questionnaire, including qualifying and non-qualifying questions. Non-qualifying questions contained in sections 1 and 3 of the questionnaire and aim to collect basic information about applicant entities, and to help applicants understand GCF expectations towards the AE.

Qualifying questions are there to check if an entity is able and ready to apply for the role of an AE. They are based on the definition of this role as defined by the GCF Board (please see section 2 of the questionnaire).

The matters that pre-screening qualifying questions look for include:

**Legal Status (legal personality and capacity):** an entity must have independent legal personality and have the capacity to enter into financing agreements with GCF in its own name. As a general matter, this means that an entity has the capacity to contract, acquire and dispose of property, and sue and be sued.

For governmental ministries, the relevant legal entity will typically be the Government itself, and not the ministry (though the ministry may act on behalf of the Government). For other sub-sovereign entities, such as governmental agencies, the entity will need to demonstrate that, as a matter of law, it can enter into financing agreements with multilateral funders in its own name. Alternatively, in cases, where this is not possible, the entity will need to demonstrate that, as a matter of law, it has the ability to act on behalf of and in the name of the Government. In the latter case, legally, it will be the Government that would be the accreditation application.

For non-governmental entities, including private sector entities, legal personality and capacity to enter into financing agreements with GCF will generally be established based on the legislation pursuant to which the entity is established, and the entity's incorporation/establishment documents.

For entities established pursuant to international law, legal personality and capacity to enter into financing agreements with GCF will typically be established under the instrument establishing the entity and the internal laws of the entity.

Ensuring entities' legal status is in order is step one, since GCF cannot provide financing to informal or unincorporated groups.

Ability to directly receive, and return, GCF funds, and to manage and use such funds: One practical criterion is whether an entity can directly receive and manage funds from GCF in the entity's own name without legal title to such funds passing to an intermediary prior to legal title to such funds transferring to the entity. The pre-screening will ask if an entity can receive money from GCF's Trustee into its account and handle those funds autonomously. This is crucial because an AE will receive disbursements of GCF financing for projects. For example, if an applicant is a government entity, does it have the authority to receive international funds directly, or would the money have to route through a Ministry of Finance or central bank first? If the latter, that could indicate a lack of the necessary autonomy over the receipt and management of the funds. GCF is looking for assurance that entities have the systems and permissions to manage funds on their own.

Basic eligibility and operational and programming capabilities: Beyond legal and financial requirements, GCF wants to confirm that an entity is operationally ready to eventually design and implement projects. At pre-screening, entities should demonstrate a basic level of institutional capability that provides confidence they can handle the role of an AE.

For instance, the GCF will look at whether entities have sufficient autonomy and systems within applicant entities to implement projects or programmes similar to those funded by GCF. They may ask if an entity has carried out climate-related or development projects before, or if an entity has key policies (like financial management, procurement, environmental and social safeguards, etc.) in place at a basic level. Entities do not need to prove full compliance with GCF standards and policies at this stage (that comes later during the detailed screening), but entities do need to show they are adequately prepared to proceed with an application.

Entity responses to qualifying questions will determine whether an entity will be invited to submit the full application for accreditation to GCF.

Non-qualifying questions: Pre-screening also includes questions on entities' business mandate, track record and institutional capacities relevant to engagement with GCF. They are built around the requirements an entity would be expected to meet during accreditation review and full engagement with GCF. Entities may want to consult GCF [Screening requirements](#) (if not already done) for information on what systems and policies will be reviewed during the full accreditation review process. This information helps the Secretariat to provide further guidance to entities during the accreditation process, should an entity be invited to submit an application.

#### **4. If Requirements Are Not Met: What Happens Next?**

Pre-screening is essentially a pass/fail checkpoint. So, what if after this initial review GCF concludes that an entity does not meet one or more of the core requirements or does not fit into the AE role? First, to not be discouraged – a “did not pass” at pre-screening does not mean a permanent rejection. It means either that partnering with GCF in the role of an AE is not the optimal route for an entity with this profile and mandate; or that an entity is not ready for the full accreditation review right now. The intention of GCF is to ensure the most beneficial ways of engagement, not to turn entities away for good. Here's what happens and what the options are if an entity doesn't pass the pre-screening test:

**Notification and feedback:** The GCF Secretariat will inform entities of the outcome of the pre-screening. If an entity did not meet one or more requirements, the entity will be informed about which areas were not met. For example, the feedback might say an entity lacks an independent legal mandate to sign agreements, or that the entity doesn't have a mandate to design and implement climate finance projects yet. This transparency is meant to help entities understand exactly what the potential next steps could be, should they decide to proceed with accreditation in the future.

**End of accreditation process (for now):** The current accreditation application will not move forward beyond pre-screening. The entity will not be invited to submit the full application at this stage. In practical terms, this saves the entity from paying the application fee and gathering a significant amount of documents only to be deemed ineligible later – it's tough news upfront, but it prevents wasted effort.

**Guidance on alternatives and capacity building:** Importantly, the conversation doesn't end with "no." The GCF Secretariat may guide an entity towards alternative ways to engage with GCF and/or ways to build capacity for a future accreditation attempt. Pathways that could be suggested here are:

**Seek Readiness support:** If an entity is a direct access entity, they can work with the relevant NDA to request [Readiness Programme](#) support specifically for accreditation preparation. GCF has a Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme that can fund capacity-building activities. For instance, if the pre-screening report says an entity's financial management systems are not in place, the entity may be eligible to receive a Readiness grant to upgrade those systems or train staff.

**Consider becoming an Executing Entity (EE):** Another alternative is to partner with an entity that is already accredited in the meantime. The Secretariat may suggest that the entity could first gain experience by serving as an executing entity for GCF-funded projects. Executing entities work under AEs to implement project activities on the ground. This means an entity wouldn't be accredited yet, but could still participate in GCF projects.

**Explore alternative ways of engaging with GCF:** Depending on an entity's mandate and business model, the entity could choose to become a GCF co-investor/ co-financier, sub-contractor in GCF projects, a knowledge partner, or a sub-contractor to the GCF funded activities. The GCF Secretariat will be available to discuss with entities the most suitable modality to partner with GCF.

**NDA involvement:** If an entity is a direct access applicant, note that the NDA will also be informed of the entity's pre-screening result. They are stakeholders in direct access applicants' success and can be helpful in mobilizing support. For instance, an NDA may assist an entity in tapping into Readiness Programme funds or advise on institutional changes needed. So it is important to maintain communication with the NDA throughout this process.

## **5. After Passing Pre-Screening: Moving to the Full Application**

**Congratulations** – if an entity passes the pre-screening stage, it means GCF has determined that the entity meets the basic eligibility requirements and is ready to proceed. Passing pre-screening is an important milestone, but it's still just the beginning of the full accreditation journey. Here's what happens next:

**Invitation to submit a full application:** Applicants that clear the pre-screening will receive an invitation to prepare and submit the complete accreditation application during one of the two annual application windows. In practical terms, the Secretariat will inform entities that they can move forward, and they will gain access to the digital Partner Portal to work on the full application (if entities haven't already) or during the next application window. GCF is introducing two accreditation application windows per year, each open for two months. The full application involves a much more detailed form and a suite of supporting documents to upload – essentially a comprehensive self-assessment of an entity against GCF standards.

**Preparing the full application:** In the full application, entities will need to provide evidence of policies, procedures, and track record in various areas: fiduciary management (e.g. how an entity handles funds and audits), project management, environmental and social safeguards, gender policy, anti-money laundering measures, etc. Additionally, applications must indicate the maximum environmental and social risk category of projects an entity intends to undertake (Category A/highest risk, B/medium, or C/lowest). This will define the scope of assessment – for example, if an entity only seeks Category C (low risk) accreditation, the evidence the entity needs to provide is tailored to that scope (fit-for-purpose).

**Continued support and guidance:** Passing pre-screening means GCF views an entity as a formal candidate, and the Secretariat will continue to engage with the entity as needed. The entity can expect access to application guidelines, the detailed application form, , and onboarding sessions to help new applicants. Don't hesitate to use the support offered – ask questions if instructions are unclear. The goal is to help entities submit a complete and robust application.

**Screening (detailed review) and accreditation decision:** Once the full application is submitted (and required accreditation fee is paid), the screening and review begins. The GCF Accreditation Panel (AP) and Secretariat will perform an in-depth assessment of each application against all applicable screening requirements. This is largely a desk review of applicants' documents and policies, but the reviewers may come back with clarification questions. Applicants will have opportunities to answer questions or provide additional information during this stage. GCF aims to complete this screening stage within nine months of the Secretariat/AP review. This timeline does not include time taken for applicants' to respond to inquiries related to their application. Timely conclusion of the application process depends on applicants' timely and complete responses to inquiries from the Secretariat and AP. If all goes well, an applicant will meet all the screening requirements and the Accreditation Panel will recommend applicants to the Board for approval as an AE. The final step is the Board formally approving applicants' accreditation based on that recommendation. After Board approval, applicants become accredited partners of GCF – congratulations!

**If gaps are identified:** it's worth noting that if the screening review identifies gaps in an applicant's systems/policies at the full application stage, the applicant will need to address them before re-applying. The key difference is that thanks to pre-screening, potential applicants will not be taken through the full assessment process if they lack the fundamental eligibility. So if an applicant is in this stage, the applicant is already in a good position for tackling any issues that come up. And remember, the Secretariat will continue to communicate timeline expectations so each applicant has clarity on how long each part might take.

## 6. Conclusion

The introduction of pre-screening under the RAF is intended to make the GCF accreditation journey more accessible and efficient for all parties. For prospective applicants, this means greater clarity upfront. Applicants now have a checkpoint to ensure they meet core eligibility requirements like legal status, contracting authority, financial autonomy, and basic operational capability before diving into a full application. This stage is an opportunity to confirm an applicant is able and ready and to get early feedback.

Keep the tone pragmatic but positive when approaching the pre-screening questionnaire. It may feel like an extra step, but it exists to set applicants up for success. By clearly demonstrating an entity's foundational capabilities, applicants pave the way for a smoother accreditation process. And if an entity discovers they are not quite there yet, remember that GCF offers support – whether through capacity-building funds or by allowing entities to participate in projects via other avenues in the interim. Many institutions, big and small, have grown into the AE role over time, often leveraging GCF Readiness Programme support or partnerships as stepping stones.

Good luck with the pre-screening questionnaire, and GCF looks forward to seeing entities take the next steps towards GCF accreditation!

## Key Definitions – GCF Pre-Screening Questionnaire

| <b>Terminology</b>                                                                                                       | <b>Definition</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Legal personality</b>                                                                                                 | The recognition of an entity as an independent legal entity under applicable law, with the capacity to enter into contracts, own assets, incur obligations, sue and be sued, and be held accountable in its own name.                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Government or government-controlled direct access entity</b>                                                          | A government (which may be acting through a ministry, department or similar body which is authorized to legally bind the government or State) of a recipient country or a subnational, national, or regional entity that is controlled by a government. This type of entity must be formally nominated by the relevant country's National Designated Authority (NDA). |
| <b>Self-nominating direct access entity – subnational, national or regional entity that is not government-controlled</b> | A subnational, national, or regional entity that is not controlled by a government. This type of entity does not require nomination from any country's National Designated Authority to apply for accreditation, but must consult with the relevant NDA.                                                                                                              |
| <b>Self-nominating international access entity</b>                                                                       | An international or multilateral institution seeking GCF accreditation under international access. Unlike government or government-controlled direct access entities, it does not require nomination by an NDA to apply.                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>National Designated Authority (NDA)</b>                                                                               | The country's officially designated focal point for the GCF – an institution that acts as the interface between the national government and the GCF. The NDA is responsible for endorsing GCF activities (e.g. providing no-objection or nomination letters) to ensure they align with national climate priorities.                                                   |
| <b>Pre-accreditation Readiness Support</b>                                                                               | Funding or technical assistance from GCF's Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme aimed at helping entities prepare for accreditation. This support identifies                                                                                                                                                                                                   |



|                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                     | institutional gaps and builds the capacities needed to meet GCF requirements.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Financial management and capacity assessment</b> | An evaluation of an entity's ability to manage funds and meet GCF's fiduciary standards, typically done through the Financial Management and Capacity Assessment (FMCA). It assesses the entity's financial management systems, policies, and track record to ensure readiness to handle GCF grants.                                       |
| <b>Fiduciary standards</b>                          | The financial management and accountability benchmark an entity is expected to meet. These include having strong administrative and financial controls, transparency and anti-corruption measures, and compliance systems (such as for anti-money laundering) to responsibly manage funds.                                                 |
| <b>Environmental and social safeguards (ESS)</b>    | Policies and procedures to avoid or minimize harm to people and the environment in an entity's projects. GCF requires accredited entities to identify potential environmental and social risks and manage them appropriately so that climate projects benefit communities without unintended negative impacts.                             |
| <b>Executing entity (for GCF-funded activity)</b>   | An entity that carries out or implements a GCF-funded project or programme on the ground, under the oversight of an Accredited Entity. In practice, an executing entity works in partnership with an Accredited Entity to execute project components and deliver results.                                                                  |
| <b>Fast-Track Eligibility</b>                       | Qualification for an accelerated GCF accreditation process. If an entity has already been accredited by certain international funds or institutions (for example, the GEF or Adaptation Fund) with comparable standards, you may be eligible for a streamlined review when applying to GCF.                                                |
| <b>Project Preparation Facility (PPF)</b>           | A GCF funding mechanism that provides technical and financial support (grants or services) to help develop high-quality funding proposals. The PPF offers up to USD 1.5 million per request to assist Accredited Entities – especially Direct Access Entities – and PSAA applicants in preparing full project/programme proposals for GCF. |
| <b>Project-Specific Assessment Approach (PSAA)</b>  | A pilot accreditation approach in which GCF assesses an entity's capacity to implement a single project or programme without granting                                                                                                                                                                                                      |



|                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                      | full institutional accreditation. Under the PSAA, the entity's capabilities are reviewed in parallel with the appraisal of a specific project proposal, expediting access to GCF funding for that project.                                           |
| <b>Direct Access Modality</b>        | Modality which allows sub-national, national, or regional entities legally incorporated or established in developing countries, including government or government-controlled entities, to apply for accreditation to directly access GCF resources. |
| <b>International Access Modality</b> | Modality which enables multilateral, regional, or international entities with global or cross-border mandates to seek accreditation to channel and implement GCF resources in developing countries.                                                  |

## Pre-screening questionnaire for prospective accredited entities

### Introduction

#### ***What is the purpose of this questionnaire?***

This pre-screening questionnaire is aimed at organizations seeking to partner with the Green Climate Fund (GCF) as accredited entities (AEs). It is designed to help your organization to check if it is ready and able to fulfill the role of the AE, and completing it is the first step in the GCF accreditation process. The completed questionnaire will also help the GCF Secretariat understand your institutional capacity and guide your organization towards the most appropriate form of collaboration for you.

#### ***What is the current GCF accreditation process?***

At the forty-second meeting of the GCF Board held between 30 June and 3 July 2025, the GCF Board adopted a revised accreditation framework (RAF), which streamlines accreditation into a fit-for-purpose and risk-based approach, thereby simplifying and strengthening the GCF accreditation process. The RAF promotes greater efficiency, transparency and predictability, while at the same time upholding GCF core standards on fiduciary responsibility, environmental and social safeguards, and gender equality.

The accreditation process allows GCF to channel climate finance to developing countries via a diverse network of AEs (national, regional and international institutions). These partners play a central role in helping countries design, implement, and manage climate-resilient and low-emission projects aligned with their national priorities.

#### ***Why pre-screen?***

The pre-screening process serves as an introductory review to confirm that an organization is able to meet basic eligibility and capacity requirements and is prepared to move forward in the accreditation process. Organizations that complete this stage will be invited to submit a full application during an upcoming accreditation window.

**Before you begin, please review the *Pre-screening Guidance Note* and related materials in the [GCF Resources section] (link to be inserted) for details on the process, documentation and examples of information to include.**

## Guidance for applicants on the GCF access modality

The following section guides you on which GCF access modality (direct access and international access) and (self)-nomination applies to your organization. Please review the prompts carefully and provide the information applicable to your organization type.

### 1. Please indicate your organization type:

- ☐ Government or government-controlled direct access entity
- ☐ Self-nominating entities
  - ☐ Self-nominating direct access entity - subnational, national or regional entity that is not government-controlled
  - ☐ Self-nominating international access entity

#### A. Government or government-controlled direct access entity

**A1.** Please confirm that you will attach a nomination letter from your country's national designated authority (NDA).

- ☐ Yes, the nomination letter is attached.
- ☐ No, it will be submitted later.

*Note:* The nomination letter should confirm endorsement by the NDA of your organization's intention to apply as a direct access entity.

#### Upload field:

 *Upload NDA nomination letter*

#### B. Self-nominating entities

**B1.** Please describe your engagement with the relevant **national designated authority in relation to your intention to seek accreditation to GCF (NDA)**.

Please note that this field is mandatory for self-nominating direct access entities and is recommended for self-nominating international access entities.

You may complete the *Consultation Summary Template* (available in the [Resources section] (link to be inserted)) or provide the information below.

**B2.** Please provide the following details:

| Field          | Input type | Guidance text                                                |
|----------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Country        | Drop-down  | Enter the country of your organization's registration.       |
| Contact person | Short text | Name and title of the staff member who engaged with the NDA. |

| Field                   | Input type                | Guidance text                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mode of consultation    | Drop-down                 | Select: Email/Virtual meeting/In-person meeting/Other                                                                   |
| Consultation dates      | Date field                | Indicate relevant dates of communication or meeting.                                                                    |
| NDA institution         | Short text                | Name of the NDA or focal point organization.                                                                            |
| NDA contact person      | Short text                | Name and title of the person consulted at the NDA.                                                                      |
| NDA contact information | Short text                | Email address and/or phone number.                                                                                      |
| Summary of discussion   | Long text box (100 words) | Briefly describe what was discussed (e.g. potential project ideas, collaboration opportunities, feedback from the NDA). |

#### Upload field:

 *Attach the Consultation Summary if used, and any supporting documentation (emails, meeting notes, etc.)*

*\*Tip:* Project or programme ideas discussed with the NDA should align with the country's climate priorities such as **nationally determined contributions**, **national adaptation plans**, or **long-term strategies**, and/or other national climate priorities. This list must include and is not limited to the relevant [NDAs or Focal Points](#).

### C. Structure of the questionnaire

The pre-screening questionnaire comprises three main sections. You may preview them before submission.

#### **Important:**

Questions in section 2 are **qualifying questions**.

If you answer “**No**” to any qualifying question, it indicates that your institution is not able to complete this stage at this time, may not meet the expectations of the role and responsibilities of an accredited entity as outlined in Section III of the [Accreditation Framework](#), and may need to identify another way to engage with GCF. In this case, the Secretariat will guide you on suitable next steps, which may include partnership through an existing accredited entity.

#### Section 1: General information

- 1.1. Contact information
- 1.2. Applicant type
- 1.3. Area of operation

#### Section 2: Legal status and basic eligibility

- 2.1. Legal personality and capacity
- 2.2. Basic eligibility and operational and programming capabilities
- 2.3. Supporting documentation

### **Section 3: Additional information and self-reflection**

- 3.1. Business mandate and track record
- 3.2. Fiduciary, environmental and social, and implementation responsibilities
- 3.3. Fast track eligibility
- 3.4. Engagement with GCF

## Section 1: General information

### 1.1. Contact information

- Applicant name (full legal name): (Required)\*
- Applicant acronym (if any) (Required):
- Legal address or registered office address. *If different, also provide operational address:* (Required)
- Website: (Required)
- Primary contact (name and title): (Required)
- Primary contact email: (Required)
- Primary contact phone no.: (Required)
- Secondary contact (name and title):
- Secondary contact email:
- Secondary contact phone no.:

### 1.2. Applicant type

Please select the option that best describes your organization.

#### A. Scope of operations

- ☐ International (global activities or presence)
- ☐ Regional (multi-country or regional activities)
- ☐ National (country-level activities)
- ☐ Subnational/Local
- ☐ Other (please specify): \_\_\_\_\_

#### B. Type of entity:

- ☐ Public sector – Government (which may be acting through a ministry or department)
- ☐ Public sector – Government-controlled subnational, national or regional entity (including development banks and state-owned companies)
- ☐ Private sector – Registered legal entities which are not government-controlled (e.g. for-profit entities, financial institutions)
- ☐ Multilateral or other international organization – entity formed by treaty, agreement or resolution between participating member states (including multilateral development banks)
- ☐ UN System Entity – a specialized agency, subsidiary organ or other part of the UN system
- ☐ Civil society organization/Non-governmental organization (including entities or foundations established for public or charitable purposes)

- ☐ Academic/Research institution  
☐ Other (please specify): \_\_\_\_\_

### 1.3. Area of operation

Please indicate where your organization operates (check all that applies).

- ☐ Developing countries  
☐ Least developed countries  
☐ Small island developing states  
☐ Developed countries

- Location of applicant's headquarters (select country): [drop-down]
- Location of applicant's legal incorporation or establishment (select country): [drop-down]

## Section 2: Legal status and basic eligibility

Purpose and guidance

This section aims to help both your organization and GCF confirm that the foundational elements for partnership are in place, that your institution has independent legal personality and the legal capacity to engage with international organizations, the ability to directly receive and manage GCF funds, and the systems and capacity needed to design and implement impactful climate projects.

 *Tip:* Please provide information as clearly as possible and attach supporting documentation where indicated. If you are uncertain about any requirement, contact the GCF Secretariat for clarification or to discuss alternative ways of engagement.

 *Incomplete or unclear responses may delay pre-screening. If your organization **does not** meet the expectations of the role and responsibilities of an accredited entity, the GCF Secretariat can provide guidance on alternative ways of engaging with the Fund or alternative support options.*

 **Important:**

If the applicant responded “No” to any of the questions below, the applicant may not be able to complete this stage. Please contact the **GCF Secretariat** to explore alternative forms of engagement as indicated above.

If the applicant responded “Yes”, please be aware that at the **full application stage**, you will be asked to provide supporting evidence demonstrating your organization's operational capabilities, implementation arrangements and monitoring systems. These materials will form part of the detailed due diligence review.



## 2.1. Legal personality and capacity

### Documents to prepare as applicable

Applicants are encouraged to seek legal advice and guidance before completing this section, and are requested to have the following materials ready:

1. Founding or constitutive legal document(s) confirming the organization's legal name and, if different, its operating or trade name.
2. Clarification of whether the entity is part of its country's government or holds separate legal personality (for state-linked applicants).
3. Proof of authorization to enter into international agreements, if applicable.
4. Evidence of separate legal personality and legal capacity to enter into legal agreements with GCF, confirming that the applicant:

- (a) Is a legal entity with individual juridical personality and is in good standing under the laws of its jurisdiction of incorporation or existence.

*If the entity is a state or government body, clarify whether it forms part of the sovereign government or holds separate legal personality granted by law. In the latter case, clarify whether applicable laws permit it to enter into agreements with, and receive financing from an international organization such as GCF*

- (b) Has the right to independently apply for, receive and manage international financing.

*If authorization is required, specify which authorizations are necessary and provide supporting evidence.*

- (c) Has the capacity and authority to contract independently in its own name and to enter, execute, deliver and perform its obligations under agreements with international organizations for the purpose of receiving funding.

*If the applicant is a state or government entity, or one of its instrumentalities, and must receive authorization to enter into such contracts, please indicate the legal basis and provide the evidence that clarifies which authorizations may be required.*

- 2.1.1. Does your organization possess independent legal personality under its constituent or governing documents and the laws of its establishment? **YES/ NO \***
- 2.1.2. Does your organization have legal capacity and authority pursuant to its constituent or governing documents and/or other applicable laws to enter into legal agreements with international organizations (such as GCF) in its own name and to perform its obligations thereunder? **YES/ NO \***

## 2.2. Supporting documentation

## **Upload field: \***

Please upload the supporting documents that substantiate your responses such as:

- a) Founding/incorporation/registration certificates or documents or legal charter or founding agreement
- b) Articles of Association/By-laws
- c) Ownership structure and beneficial ownership details comprising the identification of natural persons who directly or indirectly own or have controlling interest (shareholders, directors, persons having voting rights) of 10% or more
- d) Authorization to contract internationally (if required)
- e) Certificate of good standing

*\* For government or state-owned entities: specify whether your organization forms part of the government or has been granted separate legal personality and legal capacity to enter into agreements with international financial institutions such as GCF in its own name..*

## **2.3 Basic eligibility and operational and programming capabilities**

**2.3.1.** Can your organization **receive and repay funds directly** from/to the GCF Trustee (without an intermediary such as a central bank or government)? **YES/NO\***

 For any approved funding proposals, GCF funds will go directly to the applicant. Accredited entities are required to open and maintain an interest-bearing account for GCF-funded activities.

**2.3.2.** Can your organization **receive, hold and repay funds** in GCF operational currencies (USD, EUR, JPY and GBP)? **YES/NO\***

**2.3.3.** Is your organization permitted under its internal policies, national laws, or regulations to open and maintain an interest-bearing bank account for GCF funds (including any interest earned)? **YES/NO\***

**2.3.4.** Can your organization undertake the **full project and programme cycle**, including:

- a) Engaging with developing countries to align projects/programmes with their climate change priorities, strategies and programming needs?
- b) Designing projects and developing funding proposals for GCF financing?
- c) Implementing, delivering, monitoring and reporting on the results of such activities?
- d) Ensuring monitoring and reporting on all programming activities?

**YES:** Please briefly describe your approach to designing projects and developing funding proposals for GCF consideration (**200 words maximum**): [text box].

**Recommendation:** Before completing this description, please consult the [GCF website](https://www.greenclimate.fund/) for examples of approved projects.

**NO\*:** The GCF Secretariat will be pleased to discuss alternative modes of engagement with the Fund, other than the accredited entity role.

### 2.3.5 Does your organization have capacities for:

- ☐ Project implementation in line with basic fiduciary standards (including administrative and financial management, and transparency and accountability)? **YES/NO\***
- ☐ Management of environmental and social risks and application of environmental and social safeguards (ESS) standards for programming activities? **YES/NO\***
- ☐ Gender mainstreaming in programming activities? **YES/NO\***
- ☐ Monitoring, evaluation and reporting on programming activities? **YES/NO\***

## Section 3: Additional information and self-reflection

### Purpose and guidance

This section allows your organization to highlight its business mandate, track record and institutional capacities relevant to engagement with GCF. *Please respond concisely and attach supporting documents where relevant.*

### 3.1. Business mandate and track records

**3.1.1.** Please provide a brief overview of your organization's **business mandate, operational modalities, and core business areas**, including those related to climate finance.

Describe how your organization contributes to the GCF mandate **and strategic results areas** (updated Strategic Plan for the GCF 2024–2027; [USP-2](#)).

(Maximum 100 words)

[ Text Box ]

**3.1.2.** In the context of the intended programming with GCF: do you have experience of implementing climate finance and/or sustainability related projects/programmes?

**\*PLEASE NOTE** that at the pre-screening stage, a relevant track record is desirable but is **not** an obligatory prerequisite for submission of an application to GCF accreditation. Further details of a relevant track record will be collected and reviewed by the project teams at the programming stage.

- ☐ **If Yes.** please provide a brief overview, including the size of financing, location of the project, ESS risk category, financial instruments and financing modalities (i.e. grants, loans, guarantees, etc.) in a maximum of 100 words. [text box]
- ☐ **No**

Do you have a track record in the country or region of the intended programming?

- ☐ **If Yes.** please provide a brief overview of your track record in the country/countries of the region of the intended programming (maximum of 100 words). [text box]
- ☐ **No**

### 3.2. Fiduciary, environmental and social, and implementation responsibilities

## Purpose and guidance

This section allows your organization to reflect on its **institutional preparedness** to manage, implement and oversee climate-related projects and programmes in line with GCF standards and policies.

The self-assessment below supports transparency and helps identify areas where further strengthening or readiness support for your organization may be useful.

💡 Please select the option that best represents your organization's current level of capacity in each area. For reference, you may wish to review the [GCF's fiduciary, environmental and social, gender and monitoring standards](#) and policies, including on [AML/CFT](#)

### 3.2.1. Institutional capacity self-assessment

a) **Basic fiduciary standards – administrative and financial management, transparency, accountability, anti-corruption, and AML/CFT compliance**

- ☐ *Established:* Dedicated staff and mature, documented systems that are consistently applied.
- ☐ *Developing:* Policies in place, building our track record and systems.
- ☐ *Foundational:* Early stages of developing formal policies and capacity.

b) **Project/programme management capacity – procurement, contract management and oversight**

- ☐ *Established:* Dedicated staff and mature, documented systems that are consistently applied.
- ☐ *Developing:* Policies in place, building our track record and systems.
- ☐ *Foundational:* Early stages of developing formal policies and capacity.

c) **Environmental and social risk management and application of environmental and social safeguards**

- ☐ *Established:* Dedicated staff and mature, documented systems that are consistently applied.
- ☐ *Developing:* Policies in place, building our track record and systems.
- ☐ *Foundational:* Early stages of developing formal policies and capacity.

d) **Grievance redress mechanism**

- ☐ *Does your institution have a grievance mechanism? YES/NO*
- ☐ *If your answer is yes, how would you assess it?:*
  - *Established: Dedicated staff and mature, documented systems that are consistently applied.*
  - *Developing: Policies in place, building our track record and systems.*

- *Foundational: Early stages of developing formal policies and capacity.*

**e) Gender equality and social inclusion mainstreaming**

- ☐ *Established:* Dedicated staff and mature, documented systems that are consistently applied.
- ☐ *Developing:* Policies in place, building our track record and systems.
- ☐ *Foundational:* Early stages of developing formal policies and capacity.

**f) Monitoring, evaluation, reporting and verification – in line with the revised GCF monitoring and accountability framework**

- ☐ *Established:* Dedicated staff and mature, documented systems that are consistently applied.
- ☐ *Developing:* Policies in place, building our track record and systems.
- ☐ *Foundational:* Early stages of developing formal policies and capacity.

**3.2.2. Will you be able to demonstrate:**

a) The capacity to ensure that downstream executing entities and partners apply relevant GCF safeguards, fiduciary requirements and policies for GCF-funded activities?

**YES/NO**

b) The ability to monitor, report and verify that the above safeguards, fiduciary requirements, and policies for GCF-funded activities are being upheld?

**YES/NO**

**PLEASE NOTE** that at the application stage, you will be required to provide evidence demonstrating your institutional capacity to fulfill the fiduciary, environmental, and social responsibilities of an AE, in particular, to manage and oversee climate change projects in line with GCF standards and policies, including a track record, as appropriate, of implementing such institutional systems, policies and procedures for undertaking projects and programmes.

Please make sure that your responses are based on your knowledge and understanding of the GCF screening requirements and relevant GCF standards and policies ([GCF/B.42/04/Add.01 Annex II](#)).

**3.3. Fast-track eligibility (if applicable)**

💡 This section applies only if your organization has been accredited or assessed by any of the below-mentioned institutions

Please provide information that supports your eligibility for fast-track accreditation, including accreditation/assessment references, dates and scope if applicable.

### Upload field:

 Upload accreditation/assessment reference.

#### 3.3.1 Existing accreditations

Has your organization been accredited or assessed by any of the following institutions? Please select all applicable options

- Global Environment Facility (GEF)
- Adaptation Fund (AF)
- European Union's Directorate-General for International Partnerships (EU DG INTPA)

If **Yes**, please indicate whether your organization remains in full compliance with relevant accreditation requirements of the above institutions.

[Text box 100 words]

**3.3.2. Please note this section is under development and will be available later in 2026 to address expansion of the fast track modality approved at B.42**

#### 3.4. Engagement with GCF

Please answer the following questions on the applicant's engagement with GCF:

- Has your organization requested or received pre-accreditation readiness support from GCF?

**YES/NO**

- Has your organization served as an executing entity for any GCF-funded activity?

**YES/NO**

If **Yes**, please provide information on which projects. [Text box for 100 words]

- Has your organization served as a delivery partner for [Readiness Proposals](#) or [Project Preparation Facility Proposals](#)?

**YES/NO**

- Has your organization engaged in project-specific assessment approach proposal origination discussions?

**YES/NO**

#### 3.5. Partnerships

Is your organization prepared to undertake projects or programmes originated by other organizations or to participate in co-financed or sponsored initiatives?

- ☐ Yes      - ☐ No

*Partnerships are encouraged to leverage complementary strengths, enhance efficiency and promote country ownership.*

---

### Questionnaire successfully submitted!

Thank you for completing the **Pre-Screening Questionnaire for Prospective Accredited Entities**.

Your responses have been successfully recorded.

### What happens next?

Your submission has been received by the **GCF Secretariat** and will now be reviewed as part of the **pre-screening process**.

This review serves as a preliminary check to confirm that your organization meets the **basic eligibility criteria** to fulfill the role and responsibilities of a **GCF accredited entity** and is adequately prepared to proceed with the accreditation application.

If your organization successfully clears the pre-screening stage, the GCF Secretariat will contact you with an invitation to submit **an application for accreditation** during an open **application window**.

### Next steps and resources

For more information on the accreditation process and upcoming application windows, please visit:

**Green Climate Fund – Accreditation Website (link)**

If you have questions or require clarification, contact:

[dinvs.pre.screening@gcfund.org](mailto:dinvs.pre.screening@gcfund.org)

---

If the candidate does not pass:

### Thank you for your interest!

We appreciate your interest in partnering with the **Green Climate Fund (GCF)**.

Based on your responses, the **accredited entity (AE) pathway** may not be the best fit for your organization at this time. Your responses indicate that some of the **basic requirements for the AE role**, as defined by the GCF Board, are not currently met. This is common for many organizations exploring initial engagement with the Fund. However, the GCF offers several other ways to collaborate and strengthen institutional readiness for future accreditation.



## Alternative pathways for engagement

### 1. Executing entity

Collaborate with an existing accredited entity to implement GCF-funded projects and programmes.

### 2. Delivery partner

Support the implementation of readiness and preparatory activities under the **GCF Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme**.

### 3. Readiness support

Access readiness funding to strengthen your institution's capacities for future accreditation and partnership with GCF.

### 4. Partnership arrangements

Engage in partnerships or sponsorship arrangements with accredited entities to jointly develop and deliver climate-finance activities.

## What happens next?

We encourage you to contact the **GCF Secretariat** to discuss the most appropriate pathway for your organization's engagement with the Fund.

Our team can guide you on the next steps, and eligibility and support options tailored to your institutional context.

✉ **Contact:** [dinvs.pre.screening@gcfund.org](mailto:dinvs.pre.screening@gcfund.org)

🌐 **Visit:** [www.greenclimate.fund](http://www.greenclimate.fund)

**Thank you again for your commitment to advancing climate action.**

GCF looks forward to exploring opportunities to collaborate with your organization in the future.